

Week 1

Dot-free notation:

Sequence (of vectors):

$$\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n = (\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n) = (\mathbf{v}_j)_{j=1}^n$$

$_{j=1}^n$: “all j such that $1 \leq j \leq n$, in increasing order”

$n = 2$: $(\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2)$

$n = 1$: $(\mathbf{v}_1)$

$n = 0$: $()$ (empty sequence)

Linear combination:

$$\lambda_1 \mathbf{v}_1 + \lambda_2 \mathbf{v}_2 + \dots + \lambda_n \mathbf{v}_n = \sum_{j=1}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$$

$n = 2$: $\lambda_1 \mathbf{v}_1 + \lambda_2 \mathbf{v}_2$

$n = 1$: $\lambda_1 \mathbf{v}_1$

$n = 0$: $\mathbf{0}$ (without moving, we’re stuck at $\mathbf{0}$)

Set (of vectors):

$$\{\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n\} = \{\mathbf{v}_j : j \in [n]\}, \quad [n] = \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$$

Vectors:

$$\begin{pmatrix} v_1 \\ v_2 \\ \vdots \\ v_m \end{pmatrix} = (v_i)_{i=1}^m \quad \left| \quad \begin{aligned} (0)_{i=1}^6 &= \mathbf{0} \in \mathbb{R}^6, & (i^2)_{i=1}^5 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 4 \\ 9 \\ 16 \\ 25 \end{pmatrix}, & (v_i)_{i=1}^0 &= () \in \mathbb{R}^0 \end{aligned} \right.$$

Scalar products, lengths and angles (Section 1.2)

Scalar product: multiply two vectors: $\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} = 1 \cdot 3 + 2 \cdot 4 = 11$.

Definition 1.9: Let

$$\mathbf{v} = \begin{pmatrix} v_1 \\ v_2 \\ \vdots \\ v_m \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{w} = \begin{pmatrix} w_1 \\ w_2 \\ \vdots \\ w_m \end{pmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^m.$$

The scalar product of $\mathbf{v}$ and $\mathbf{w}$ is the number

$$\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w} := v_1 w_1 + v_2 w_2 + \cdots + v_m w_m = \sum_{i=1}^m v_i w_i.$$

Observation 1.10: Let $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be vectors and $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$ a scalar. Then

- (i) $\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{w} \cdot \mathbf{v}$
- (ii) $(\lambda \mathbf{v}) \cdot \mathbf{w} = \lambda(\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w}) = \mathbf{v} \cdot (\lambda \mathbf{w})$
- (iii) $\mathbf{u} \cdot (\mathbf{v} + \mathbf{w}) = \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{v} + \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{w}$ and $(\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}) \cdot \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{w} + \mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w}$
- (iv) $\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{v} \geq 0$, with equality exactly if $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}$

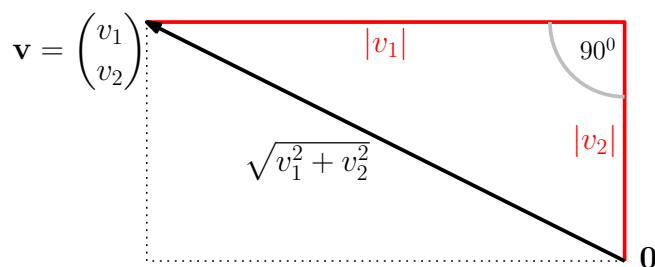
Euclidean norm: defines length of a vector

Definition 1.11: Let $\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^m$. The Euclidean norm of $\mathbf{v}$ is the number

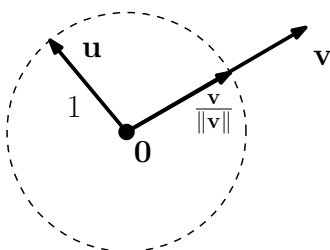
$$\|\mathbf{v}\| := \sqrt{\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{v}}.$$

$$\left\| \begin{pmatrix} v_1 \\ v_2 \\ \vdots \\ v_m \end{pmatrix} \right\| = \sqrt{v_1^2 + v_2^2 + \cdots + v_m^2} = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^m v_i^2} \quad \left\| \begin{pmatrix} -4 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} \right\| = \sqrt{(-4)^2 + 2^2} = \sqrt{20}$$

In $\mathbb{R}^2$: arrow length (Pythagoras!)



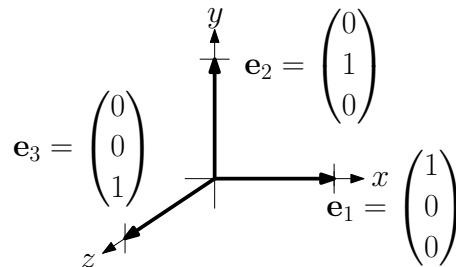
Unit vector: $\|\mathbf{u}\| = 1$.



For $\mathbf{v} \neq \mathbf{0}$, $\frac{\mathbf{v}}{\|\mathbf{v}\|} := \frac{1}{\|\mathbf{v}\|}\mathbf{v}$ is a unit vector.

Standard unit vectors:

$$\mathbb{R}^3 : \mathbf{e}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{e}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{e}_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad \bigg| \quad \mathbb{R}^m : \mathbf{e}_i = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \leftarrow \text{coordinate } i$$



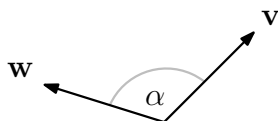
Cauchy-Schwarz inequality (Proof and application in lecture notes):

Lemma 1.12: For any two vectors $\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^m$,

$$|\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w}| \leq \|\mathbf{v}\| \|\mathbf{w}\|.$$

Equality holds exactly if one vector is a scalar multiple of the other.

Angle between two vectors:



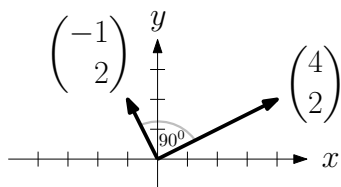
Definition 1.14: Let $\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be two nonzero vectors. The angle between them is the unique α between 0 and π (180 degrees) such that

$$\cos(\alpha) = \underbrace{\frac{\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w}}{\|\mathbf{v}\| \|\mathbf{w}\|}}_{\uparrow \text{ between } -1 \text{ and } 1 \text{ by Cauchy-Schwarz}}, \text{ or } \alpha = \arccos\left(\frac{\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w}}{\|\mathbf{v}\| \|\mathbf{w}\|}\right).$$

In $\mathbb{R}^2$: the usual angle

Orthogonal vectors:

Definition 1.15: Vectors $\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ are *orthogonal* (or *perpendicular*) if $\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w} = 0$ (same as $\cos(\alpha) = 0$, or 90 degrees).



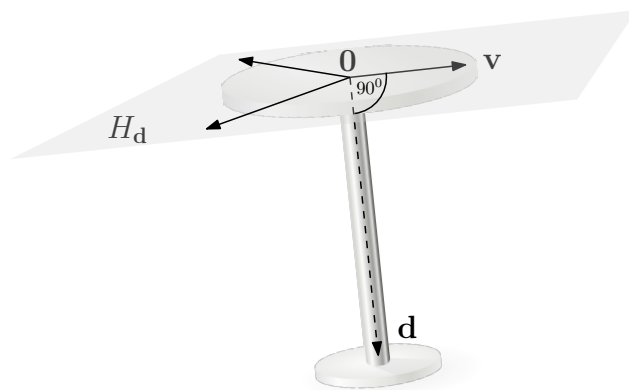
$$\begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} = -4 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 2 = 0$$

Hyperplanes:

Definition 1.16: Let $\mathbf{d} \in \mathbb{R}^m, \mathbf{d} \neq \mathbf{0}$. The set

$$H_{\mathbf{d}} = \{\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^m : \mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{d} = 0\}$$

is a *hyperplane* through the origin.

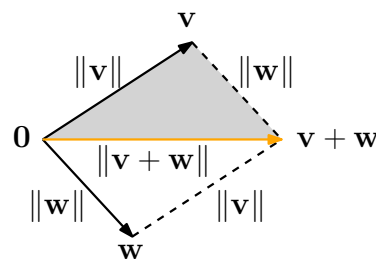


Triangle inequality (proof from Cauchy-Schwarz):

Lemma 1.17: Let $\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^m$. Then

$$\|\mathbf{v} + \mathbf{w}\| \leq \|\mathbf{v}\| + \|\mathbf{w}\|.$$

In $\mathbb{R}^2$: From 0 directly to $\mathbf{v} + \mathbf{w}$ is shorter than via $\mathbf{v}$ or $\mathbf{w}$:



Covectors and $\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{w}$:

Other notations for $\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w}$ (scalar product): $\langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w} \rangle$ and $\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{w}$.

$\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{w}$: used from now on and very useful in connection with matrices (Chapter 2).

If $\mathbf{v}$ is a vector (column vector), then $\mathbf{v}^\top$ is a *covector* (row vector):

$$\mathbf{v} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{v}^\top = (1 \quad 2), \quad (\mathbf{v}^\top)^\top = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Scalar product as covector-vector multiplication:

Definition 1.19: Let $\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^m$. Then

$$\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{w} = (v_1 \quad v_2 \quad \cdots \quad v_m) \begin{pmatrix} w_1 \\ w_2 \\ \vdots \\ w_m \end{pmatrix} := \sum_{i=1}^m v_i w_i = \mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{w}.$$

Linear independence (Section 1.3)

Linear (in)dependence:

Definition 1.21: Vectors $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n$ are *linearly dependent* if at least one of them is a linear combination of the others, i.e. there exists an index $k \in [n]$ and scalars λ_j such that

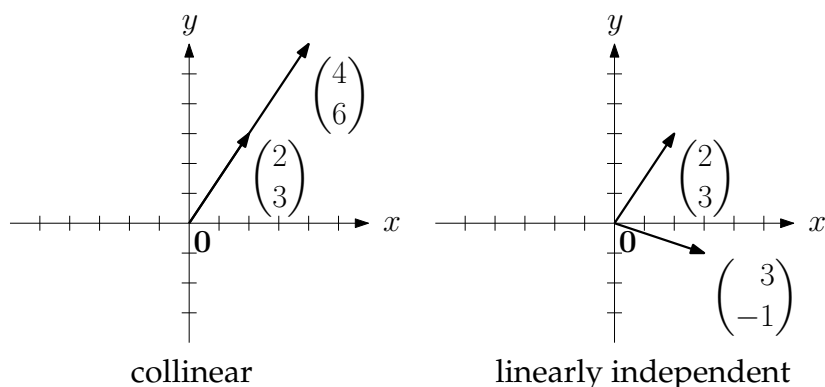
$$\mathbf{v}_k = \sum_{\substack{j=1 \\ j \neq k}}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j.$$

Otherwise, $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n$ are *linearly independent*.

" $j \neq k$ ": an additional condition on j (all j except k).

$\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 6 \end{pmatrix}$ are linearly dependent: $\begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 6 \end{pmatrix} = 2 \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}$.

$\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$ are linearly independent.



Three vectors in $\mathbb{R}^2$ are linearly dependent: either two are collinear, or each is a linear combination of the other two (Challenge 1.6).

linearly independent	linearly dependent
$\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$	
	$\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 6 \end{pmatrix}$
	$\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \mathbf{v}_3 \in \mathbb{R}^2$
$\mathbf{v} \neq \mathbf{0}$	
	$\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}$
	$\dots, \mathbf{0}, \dots$
	$\dots, \mathbf{v}, \dots, \mathbf{v}, \dots$
empty sequence	

Alternative definitions:

Lemma 1.22: Let $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n \in \mathbb{R}^m$. The following statements are *equivalent* (all true, or all false).

- (i) At least one of the vectors is a linear combination of the other ones (linearly dependent by Definition 1.21).
- (ii) There are scalars $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \dots, \lambda_n$ besides $0, 0, \dots, 0$ such that $\sum_{j=1}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j = \mathbf{0}$. Math jargon: $\mathbf{0}$ is a *nontrivial linear combination* of the vectors.
- (iii) At least one of the vectors is a linear combination of the previous ones.

Proof idea:

(i) *implies* (ii): if (i) is true, then also (ii) is true.

(i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii)

(ii) *implies* (iii).

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (iii)

(iii) *implies* (i).

(iii) $\Rightarrow$ (i)

Each statement implies the other ones!

(i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iii)

Math prose for (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii):

(i) *if and only if* (ii)

Proof.

(i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii): Let

$$\mathbf{v}_k = \sum_{\substack{j=1 \\ j \neq k}}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j.$$

Define $\lambda_k = -1$. We get (ii):

$$\mathbf{0} = \sum_{j=1}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j.$$

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (iii): Let k be the largest index such that $\lambda_k \neq 0$. Then

$$\mathbf{0} = \sum_{j=1}^k \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j$$

and we get (iii):

$$\mathbf{v}_k = \sum_{j=1}^{k-1} \left(-\frac{\lambda_j}{\lambda_k} \right) \mathbf{v}_j.$$

(iii) $\Rightarrow$ (i): a linear combination of the previous ones is also a linear combination of the other ones. $\square$

For linear independence, take the opposite statements.

Corollary 1.23: Let $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n \in \mathbb{R}^m$. The following statements are equivalent (all true, or all false).

- (i) None of the vectors is a linear combination of the other ones (linearly independent by Definition 1.21.)
- (ii) There are no scalars $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \dots, \lambda_n$ besides $0, 0, \dots, 0$ such that $\sum_{j=1}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j = \mathbf{0}$. Math jargon: $\mathbf{0}$ can only be written as a *trivial linear combination* of the vectors.
- (iii) None of the vectors is a linear combination of the previous ones.

Uniqueness of linear combination:

Lemma 1.24: Let $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be linearly independent, and let $\mathbf{w} = \sum_{j=1}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j = \sum_{j=1}^n \mu_j \mathbf{v}_j$ be two ways of writing $\mathbf{w}$ as a linear combination. Then $\lambda_j = \mu_j$ for all $j \in [n]$.

Proof. Subtraction:

$$\mathbf{0} = \sum_{j=1}^n (\lambda_j - \mu_j) \mathbf{v}_j.$$

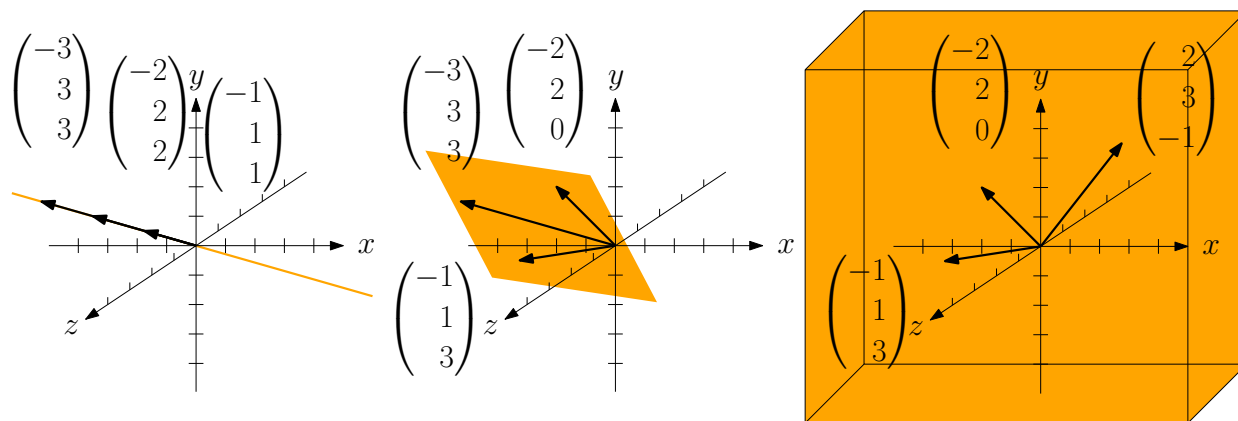
Since $\mathbf{0}$ can only be written as a trivial linear combination, we get $\lambda_j - \mu_j = 0$ for all j . $\square$

Span of vectors: set of all linear combinations

Definition 1.25: Let $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n \in \mathbb{R}^m$. Their *span* is

$$\text{Span}(\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n) := \left\{ \sum_{j=1}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j : \lambda_j \in \mathbb{R} \text{ for all } j \in [n] \right\}.$$

Span of three vectors in $\mathbb{R}^3$:



a line

...or a point (if all vectors are $\mathbf{0}$)

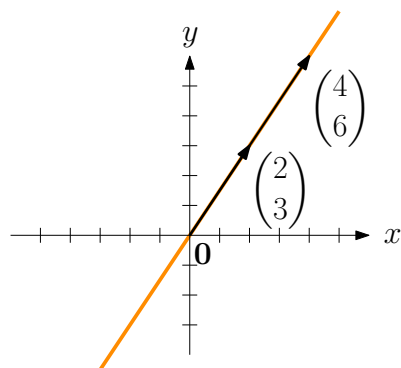
a plane

the whole space

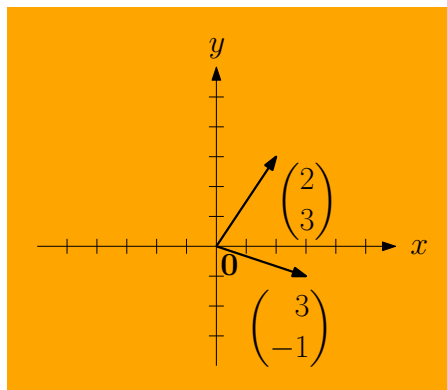
Always: $\mathbf{0} \in \text{Span}(\dots)$

Fact 1.5:

$$\text{Span} \left(\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} \right) = \mathbb{R}^2.$$



collinear



linearly independent

Lemma 1.26: Let $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n \in \mathbb{R}^m$, and let $\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be a linear combination of $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n$. Then

$$\underbrace{\text{Span}(\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n)}_S = \underbrace{\text{Span}(\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n, \mathbf{v})}_T.$$

Proof idea:

Each element of S is contained in T (S is subset of T).

$$S \subseteq T$$

T is subset of S .

$$T \subseteq S$$

The two sets are equal!

$$S = T$$

Proof. $S \subseteq T$: Each $\mathbf{w} \in S$ is a linear combination of $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n$ and therefore of $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n, \mathbf{v}$ (add scalar multiple $0\mathbf{v}$). So $\mathbf{w} \in T$.

$T \subseteq S$: each $\mathbf{w} \in T$ is a linear combination of $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n, \mathbf{v}$,

$$\mathbf{w} = \sum_{j=1}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j + \lambda \mathbf{v}.$$

We know: $\mathbf{v}$ is a linear combination of $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n$,

$$\mathbf{v} = \sum_{j=1}^n \mu_j \mathbf{v}_j.$$

Together:

$$\mathbf{w} = \sum_{j=1}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j + \lambda \mathbf{v} = \sum_{j=1}^n \lambda_j \mathbf{v}_j + \lambda \left(\sum_{j=1}^n \mu_j \mathbf{v}_j \right) = \sum_{j=1}^n (\lambda_j + \lambda \mu_j) \mathbf{v}_j.$$

So $\mathbf{w}$ is a linear combination of $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n$, $\mathbf{w} \in S$. □